

THE FROM RELIGIOUS DIVISION TO THE ARMADA: HOW DID ELIZABETH SECURE HER THRONE? DOSSIER: KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569-88

78 Crucial Questions. Complete Knowledge Mastery.

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- ☐ **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- ☐ **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- ☐ **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	Which Protestant Bishop of Durham did the Northern Earls strongly resent?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Which two Catholic nobles led the Revolt of the Northern Earls in 1569?	☐	☐	☐	
3	What major religious building did the Northern Earls capture to celebrate a Catholic Mass?	☐	☐	☐	
4	Roughly how many rebels did Elizabeth execute after the Northern Earls' revolt?	☐	☐	☐	
5	What was the theological meaning of the 1570 Papal excommunication?	☐	☐	☐	
6	What strict law was passed in 1581 regarding Catholic conversions?	☐	☐	☐	
7	Who was the Italian banker that orchestrated a plot in 1571?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Which foreign commander was supposed to lead 10,000 Spanish troops during the Ridolfi Plot?	☐	☐	☐	
9	Which high-ranking English nobleman was executed in 1572 for his involvement in the Ridolfi Plot?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Which plot in 1583 involved the French Duke of Guise invading England with Spanish money?	☐	☐	☐	
11	What document was created after the Throckmorton Plot stating Mary would be killed if Elizabeth was assassinated?	☐	☐	☐	
12	Who was Elizabeth's Secretary of State and Spymaster?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
13	What term is used for spies, like Gilbert Gifford, who secretly encourage others to commit treason?	☐	☐	☐	
14	Who was the expert cryptographer that deciphered Mary's letters for Walsingham?	☐	☐	☐	
15	Which 1586 plot provided the final, irrefutable written proof of Mary's guilt?	☐	☐	☐	
16	What specific Act of Parliament was used to try and convict Mary, Queen of Scots?	☐	☐	☐	
17	In what year was Mary, Queen of Scots executed?	☐	☐	☐	
18	Name two "new men" at court whose rise to power angered the old northern nobility.	☐	☐	☐	
19	What did Walsingham find in Francis Throckmorton's house that caused immense panic?	☐	☐	☐	
20	Which Spanish Ambassador was expelled following the discovery of the Throckmorton Plot?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT2.2: Relations with Spain

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	Who was the devout Catholic King of Spain during Elizabeth's reign?	☐	☐	☐	
22	What term describes sailors officially licensed by the government to rob enemy ships?	☐	☐	☐	
23	Which famous English privateer stole roughly £400,000 of Spanish treasure during his circumnavigation?	☐	☐	☐	
24	What region did Spain control that Elizabeth sent troops to support in 1585?	☐	☐	☐	
25	What was the name of the 1585 treaty where Elizabeth officially supported the Dutch rebels?	☐	☐	☐	
26	Which English commander was sent to the Netherlands with 7,400 troops?	☐	☐	☐	
27	What 1587 event removed the Catholic alternative to the English throne, prompting Philip to invade?	☐	☐	☐	
28	In what year did Francis Drake raid Cadiz to delay the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
29	What famous phrase was used to describe Drake's raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
30	In what year did the Spanish Armada set sail?	☐	☐	☐	
31	Who was the inexperienced Spanish commander of the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
32	Whose army was the Armada supposed to pick up from the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
33	What defensive shape did the Spanish fleet sail in as they travelled up the English Channel?	☐	☐	☐	
34	What type of new, fast, and highly manoeuvrable warships did the English use?	☐	☐	☐	
35	Where did the Spanish mistakenly drop their anchors, making them vulnerable?	☐	☐	☐	
36	What devastating tactic did the English use at midnight to break the Spanish formation at Calais?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What major naval battle took place immediately after the fireships scattered the Spanish fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
38	Why couldn't the Armada pick up the Spanish army in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Which way was the Armada forced to sail to get home?	☐	☐	☐	
40	What destroyed the majority of the Spanish ships as they tried to return home?	☐	☐	☐	

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KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	Under which previous monarch were England and Spain actually allies?	☐	☐	☐	
42	What did Elizabeth seize from Italian ships sheltering in English ports in 1568?	☐	☐	☐	
43	How much Spanish gold and silver did Francis Drake capture between 1577 and 1580?	☐	☐	☐	
44	Which Dutch Protestant rebel leader was assassinated in 1584?	☐	☐	☐	
45	Which 1584 treaty allied Catholic France and Spain together?	☐	☐	☐	
46	What 1585 agreement saw Elizabeth officially pledge military support to the Dutch rebels?	☐	☐	☐	
47	How many soldiers did Elizabeth agree to send to the Netherlands in 1585?	☐	☐	☐	
48	Which English commander was sent to lead the troops in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
49	What title did Robert Dudley accept in the Netherlands that infuriated Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
50	Name one of the English officers who defected to the Spanish side, damaging Dutch trust.	☐	☐	☐	
51	What deep-water port did Dudley successfully prevent the Spanish from capturing?	☐	☐	☐	
52	Why was the defense of Ostend so important for England's future?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
53	In what month and year did Francis Drake launch his preemptive raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
54	What famous phrase was used to describe Drake's raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
55	Roughly how many Spanish ships did Drake destroy in Cadiz harbour?	☐	☐	☐	
56	What crucial supply item did Drake destroy at Cadiz that later caused Spanish food to rot?	☐	☐	☐	
57	How long did Drake's raid on Cadiz delay the launch of the Spanish Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
58	Why was this delay so significant for Elizabeth's government?	☐	☐	☐	
59	Who had Elizabeth rejected a marriage proposal from in 1559?	☐	☐	☐	
60	Which Pope gave his blessing to the Armada, turning it into a Catholic crusade?	☐	☐	☐	

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KT2.4: The Armada

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	How much money did the Pope promise Philip if the Armada was successful?	☐	☐	☐	
62	What 1584 treaty between France and Spain isolated England and pushed Philip closer to war?	☐	☐	☐	
63	The execution of which monarch in 1587 gave Philip II his final political motivation to invade?	☐	☐	☐	
64	What was the name of the inexperienced commander chosen by Philip to lead the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
65	How many ships made up the Spanish Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
66	What highly effective, defensive shape did the Spanish fleet sail in?	☐	☐	☐	
67	Who commanded the Spanish land army waiting in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
68	What type of small rebel ships blockaded the Spanish army in the shallow coastal waters?	☐	☐	☐	
69	At which port did the Armada mistakenly drop anchor to wait for the land army?	☐	☐	☐	
70	What devastating tactic did the English use at midnight to break the Spanish formation?	☐	☐	☐	
71	How many fireships did the English send into the Spanish fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
72	What was the name of the major naval battle that took place the day after the fireships were used?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
73	Why were English cannons able to fire more quickly than the Spanish during this battle?	☐	☐	☐	
74	Which way was the Armada forced to sail to escape the English fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
75	What nickname did the English give to the storms that destroyed the fleeing Spanish ships?	☐	☐	☐	
76	Where did Elizabeth deliver her famous speech to her troops ("I have the heart and stomach of a king")?	☐	☐	☐	
77	What famous piece of propaganda was painted to celebrate the victory?	☐	☐	☐	
78	Did the defeat of the Armada in 1588 mean the end of the war with Spain?	☐	☐	☐	

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

1. James Pilkington
2. The Earl of Northumberland and the Earl of Westmorland
3. Durham Cathedral
4. 450
5. Being formally excluded from the Catholic Church and unable to receive sacraments
6. It became high treason to convert anyone to Catholicism
7. Roberto Ridolfi
8. The Duke of Alba
9. The Duke of Norfolk
10. The Throckmorton Plot
11. The Bond of Association
12. Sir Francis Walsingham
13. Agents provocateurs
14. Thomas Phelippes
15. The Babington Plot
16. The Act for the Preservation of the Queen's Safety
17. 1587
18. William Cecil, Robert Dudley, or John Forster
19. A list of Catholic sympathisers / proof of the "enemy within"
20. Mendoza

KT2.2: Relations with Spain

21. King Philip II
22. Privateers
23. Sir Francis Drake
24. The Netherlands
25. The Treaty of Nonsuch
26. The Earl of Leicester / Robert Dudley
27. The execution of Mary, Queen of Scots
28. 1587

29. "Singeing the King of Spain's beard"
30. 1588
31. The Duke of Medina Sidonia
32. The Duke of Parma's army
33. A crescent formation
34. Galleons
35. Calais
36. Fireships
37. The Battle of Gravelines
38. Poor communication / Parma's army was not ready in time
39. North, around the coasts of Scotland and Ireland
40. Fierce storms / The weather / The "Protestant Wind"

KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

41. Mary Tudor
42. The Genoese Loan
43. £400,000
44. William of Orange
45. The Treaty of Joinville
46. The Treaty of Nonsuch
47. 7,400 troops
48. Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester
49. Governor General
50. William Stanley or Rowland York
51. Ostend
52. It meant the Spanish Armada wouldn't have a deep-water port to pick up troops from a year later
53. April 1587
54. "Singeing the King of Spain's beard"
55. 30 ships
56. Seasoned wooden barrel staves
57. By roughly one year
58. It bought England vital time to prepare their navy and coastal defences
59. King Philip II of Spain
60. Pope Sixtus V



KT2.4: The Armada

61. One million gold ducats
62. The Treaty of Joinville
63. Mary, Queen of Scots
64. The Duke of Medina Sidonia
65. 130
66. A crescent formation
67. The Duke of Parma
68. Dutch flyboats
69. Calais
70. Fireships
71. Eight
72. The Battle of Gravelines

- 73. They were mounted on smaller gun carriages, allowing them space to recoil and reload
- 74. Northwards, around Scotland and Ireland
- 75. The "Protestant Wind"
- 76. Tilbury
- 77. The Armada Portrait
- 78. No, the war continued for another 15 years and Philip built more armadas

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 78 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/78)	Parent/Guardian Signature	Target for Next Time
1				
2				
3				

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...